How to Take Ta'jeel and I'tithaar

Version 4, 14th August 2023.

Disclaimer: The following information is not official information from jaami'ah. It's information compiled based on what is known, given in order to help other brothers. It is advice only – the processes and rules can change at any moment in time. If you are unsure about anything it's best to go into jaami'ah and check yourself. You can follow the information in this guide, however ultimately you have to take full ownership and responsibility should you choose to follow this advice. This is just an aid for better understanding. Feel free to send me an update if you find something out after checking with any jaami'ah staff.

What is Ta'jeel?

Ta'jeel is effectively requesting a semester break, where you opt not to study and have a break in your studies. You can only apply for ta'jeel during a small window before the start of that semester.

The most you can apply for ta'jeel is for 2 semesters (1 full academic year) at any time during your course. So you can take Ta'jeel for 1 semester only, or for 2 semesters consecutively. (If you take ta'eeel for 1 semester then you can take ta'jeel for another semester again at a later date on that same course – e.g. mahad.)

If you go from Mahad to Kulliyah, then this is a new course and you will be allowed to take ta'jeel again (even if you had already taken 2 ta'jeels in mahad).

Why do students take Ta'jeel?

Students often take ta'jeel for emergencies or important situations which cannot be delayed or avoided, as doing so can cause them harm or substantial difficulty. These include: health emergencies; family emergencies; marriage and other issues related to their studies that would stop them from failing/quitting their studies, or would help/aid their studies.

Effects of taking Ta'jeel:

When you take ta'jeel:

- It doesn't affect your studies (i.e. you won't be counted as having studied that semester).
- Your mukaafa'ah (monthly stipend) will stop for the duration you are on ta'jeel.
- You need to give up your dorm room and hand in the key (taking your things out of your room).
- You must leave Saudi Arabia and go back to your country
  → If you take ta'jeel for 1 semester, you will be given an exit-re-entry visa.
  → If you take ta'jeel for 2 semesters in a row, you will be given a Final Exit Visa. **This means you will need to do the visa process all over again in order to get a new visa.**
- You will normally need to pay for your own flight tickets (as the jaami'ah only pays for your initial flight ticket as a newly accepted student, and an annual summer return ticket).

(After taking ta'jeel for 1 semester only, you are automatically enrolled back into the system for the second semester.)

When do I take ta'jeel?

Ta'jeel is taken usually a week or 2 before the start of the semester. Wait for the academic calendar to be released, and when it is released, it will state the period for requesting ta'jeel. Ta'jeel must be taken during this window. If a person misses this window, usually then they will have to apply for I'tithaar as that starts after the period for ta'jeel ends.

What is I'tithar?

After the window for ta'jeel ends (see the university academic calendar for the exact dates), you can only apply for I'itithar.

I'tithar means you are giving an excuse for suspending your studies **during the semester**. However the difference with I'tithaar is that **the jami'ah has to accept the excuse that you have given in order to suspend your studies.** If the jamiah doesn't accept the excuse, then you must continue with your studies.

I'tithaar is applied for during the semester that you are in.

Effects of taking I'tithaar:

When you take I'tithaar:
- It affects your studies (i.e. **so you are counted as having studied that semester, but not passing it.** You will need to repeat that semester again).
- Your mukaafa'ah (monthly stipend) will stop for the duration you are on I'tithaar.
- You **may** need to give up your dorm room (however some brothers have kept theirs having taken I'tithaar).
- You **may** need to leave Saudi Arabia and go back to your country.

Effects of Ta'jeel and I'tithaar on your 4-year dealine to complete your studies:

When you enter Kulliyah, you have a 4 year limit to complete your bachelors degree. You cannot go beyond this. E.g. if a person started their Kulliyah bachelor's degree in September 2023, then they have until September 2027 to finish all of the modules on their course. If they do not finish by September 2027, then they run the risk of not being able to obtain their degree certificate and may have to leave when their 4 years are finished.

For Ta'jeel: Taking Ta'jeel does not affect your 4-year limit. So using the above example, if a person took 1 ta'jeel during the period between Sept. 2023 and Sept. 2027, the deadline for finishing his degree would extend to January 2028 as he had taken ta'jeel for 1 semester.

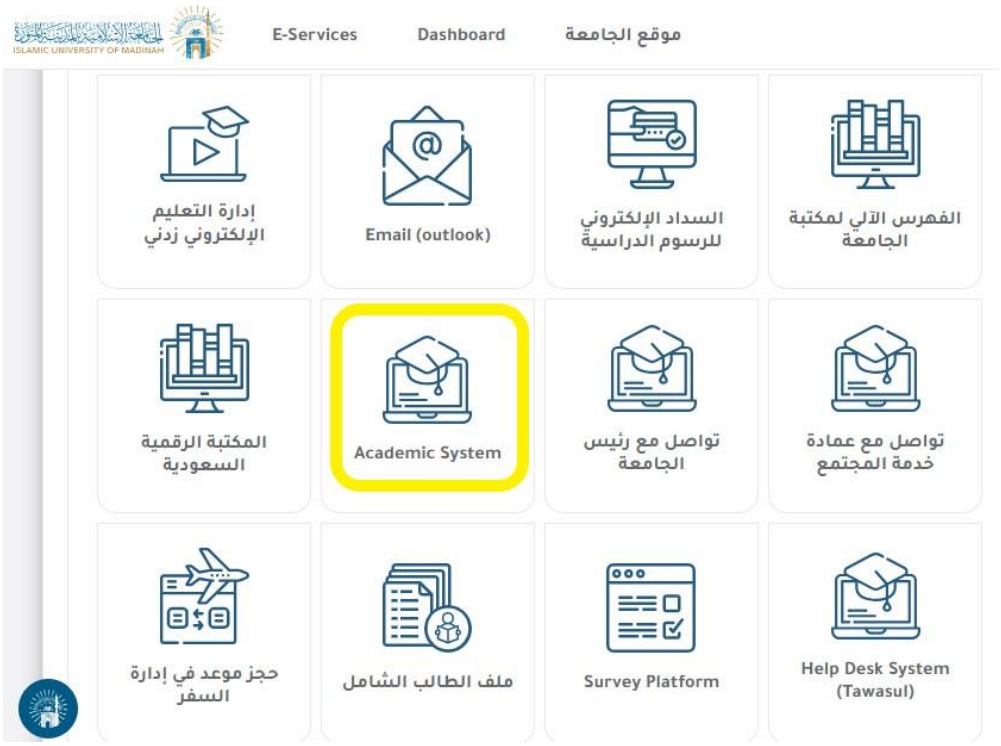
For I'tithaar: Taking I'tithaar **does** affect your 4 year limit. This means that even though you have taken I'tithaar and stopped studying for that semester, your deadline remains at the original 4 year deadline (using the example above – you still need to finish all your modules by September 2027 even if you did 1 I'tithaar. The deadline for finishing doesn't get extended by 1 semester. Therefore you will need to take the extra modules you deferred either during the remaining semesters, or during the summer in order to get all the modules finished by the deadline of September 2027. Otherwise you run the risk of not being able to obtain your degree certificate and may have to leave when the 4 years are finished.)

How to apply for Ta'jeel/I'tithaar

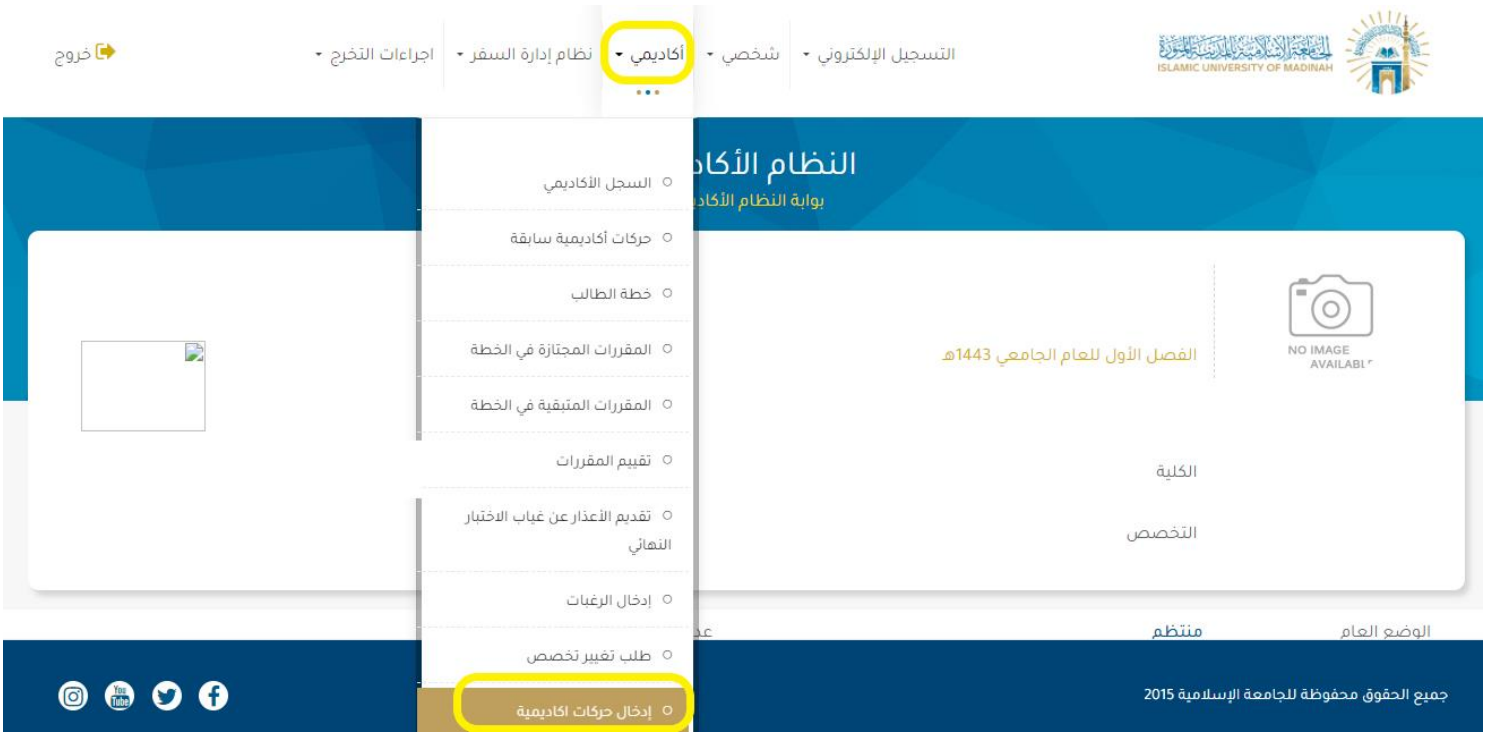
Below is the process for taking ta'jeel. However the exact processes and the time frame within which you can apply might differ depending on your kulliyah – therefore check with your kulliyah if required.

1. Login to the academic portal from here: https://cas.iu.edu.sa/cas/login

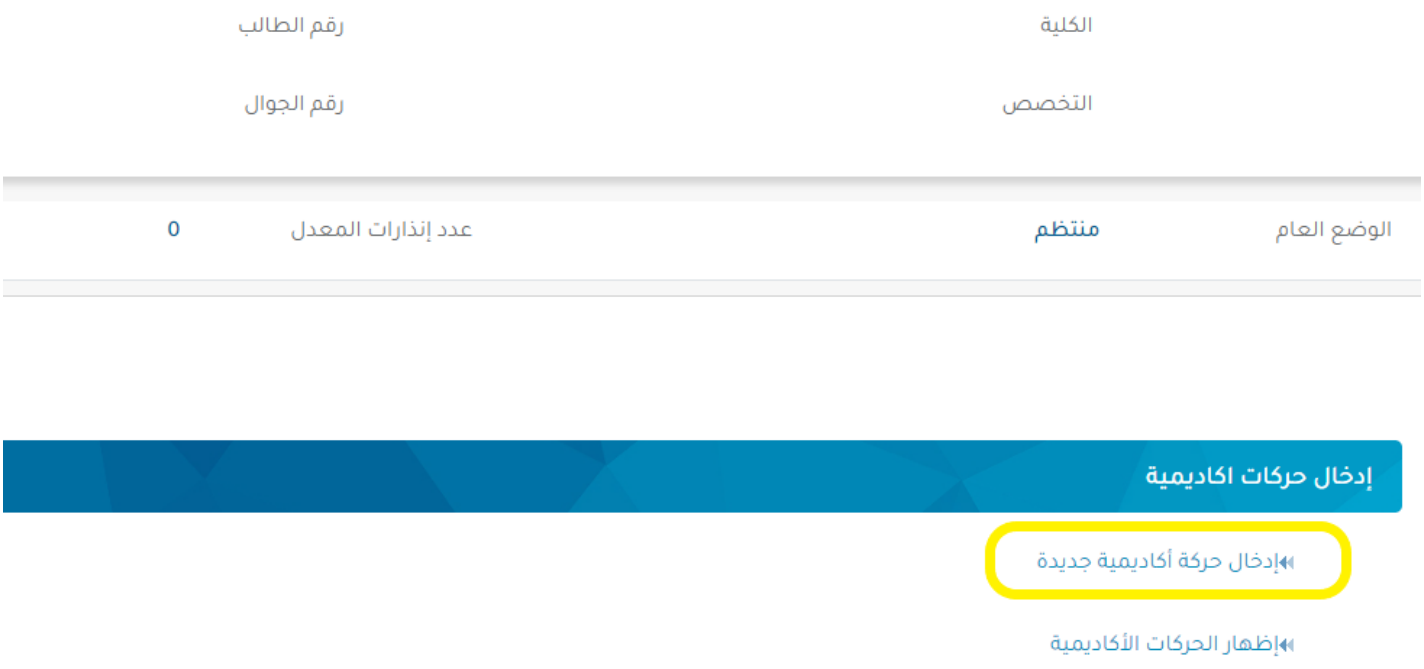
2. Click : 'Academic System'



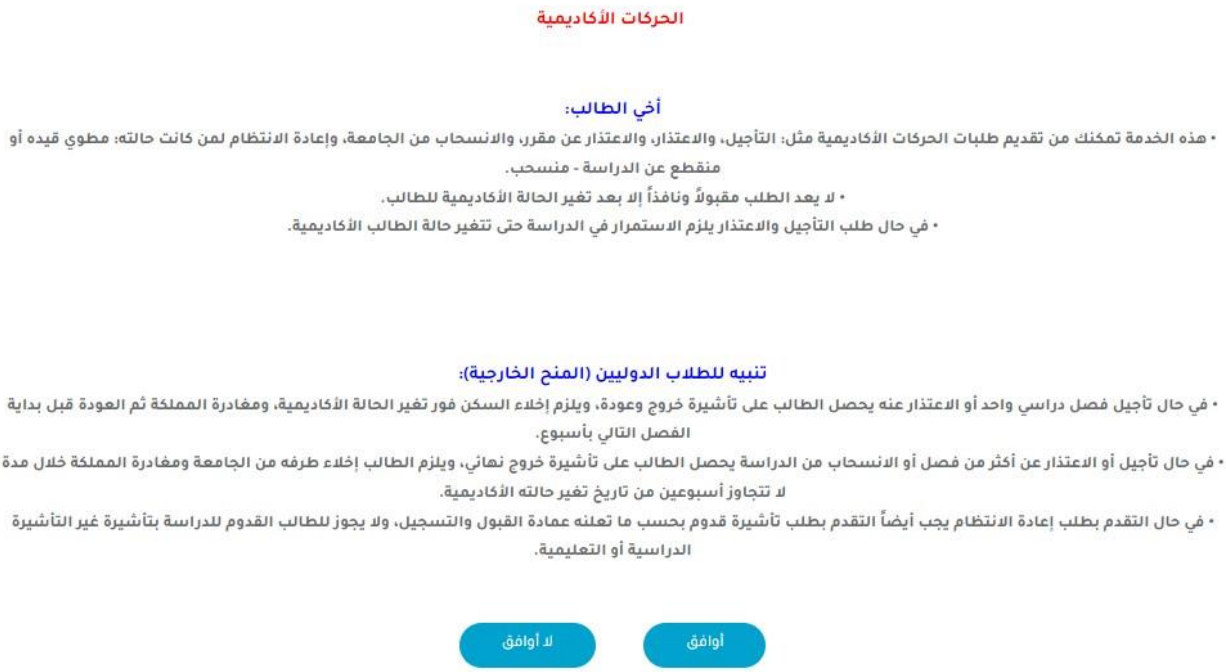
3. On the next screen, hover over the "أكاديمي" column and select "ادخال حركات اكاديمية":



4. Then scroll down and choose "ادخال حركات أكاديمية جديدة":



5. You will then see this screen:



Click “أوافق” at the bottom.

6. You will then see the following screen:



Firstly, نوع الحركة should be set to "تأجيل". The only other option at this stage before the semester starts is إنسحاب (withdrawal), which is for requesting to withdraw from your course. Do not choose this option if you wish to do ta'jeel.

Choosing the duration of ta'jeel:

IMPORTANT: If you wish to do ta'jeel for 1 semester only, then you must choose 'From Semester 1 to Semester 1'. Do not choose 'from semester 1 to semester 2).

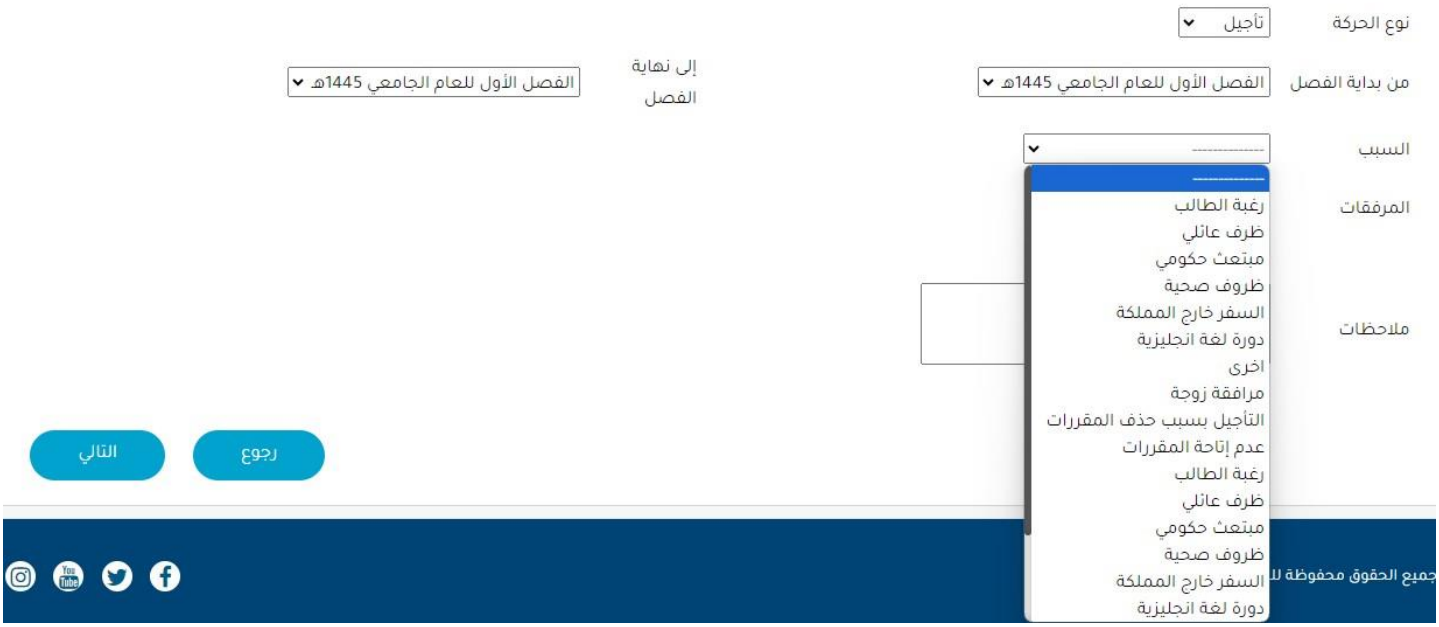
So the "من بداية الفصل" section should be:
"الفصل الأول للعام الجامعي (YEAR)".

and the "إلى نهاية الفصل" section should also be:
"الفصل الأول للعام الجامعي (YEAR)."

This means that you will do ta'jeel for 1 semester only, and you will be able to get khuruj awdah (exit re-entry visa).

If you wish to do ta'jeel **for 2 semesters**, then for the "إلى نهاية الفصل" section you will choose: "الفصل الثاني للعام الجامعي (YEAR)." This means you wish to do ta'jeel for 2 semesters (i.e. the entire year), and therefore you will be given khuruj nihaa'i (not Khuruj Awdah). (You will have to do the entire visa process again when you need to return to the university.)

7. For السبب choose the reason why you are taking ta’jeel:

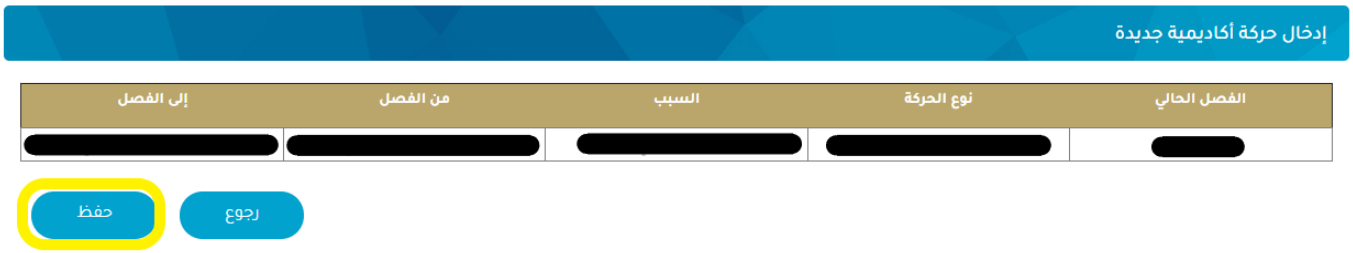


8. After you have chosen a reason, then in the box called ملاحظات you can enter any comments if you need to. Also where it says "مرفقات" you can also attach any pdf documents for supporting evidence if required (e.g. for some i’tithaar cases).



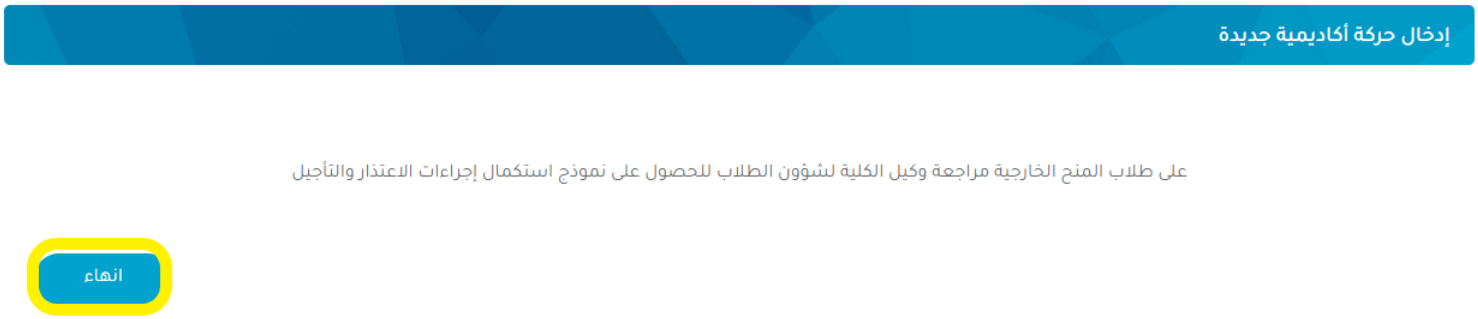
After this, click التالي to proceed.

9. You will then see the following screen summarising your request:



Click: "حفظ" to submit your request.

10. You will then see the following screen:



The statement on this screen reads: *"The student for external scholarships should go to the wakeel of his kulliyah (who is responsible for student affairs) - in order to obtain a form for completing the ta'jeel and I'tithaar requests."*

So it states that (after you've finished), the student should go and see the wakeel of their kulliayh/mahad to see if there are any other forms/procedures that might need to be done in order to complete the ta'jeel request.

Click انهاء. You have now put through your ta'jeel request.

11. You can check your request by following steps 1-3, however, at step 4 choose "إظهار الحركات الأكاديمية"



12. You will then see a summary of your request and it's current status:



How to take I'tithaar:

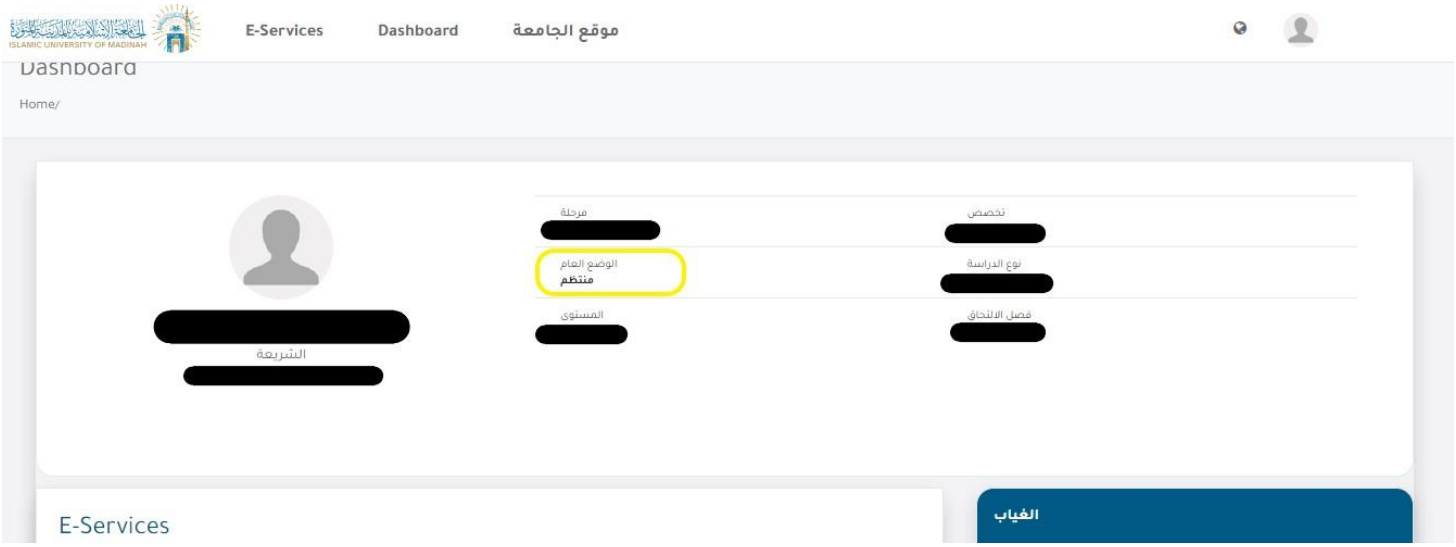
For I'tithaar, you will follow the same process, however at Step 6, make sure that for "نوع الحركة" you choose "الاعتذار" and not ta'jeel. (This option should become available after the period for ta'jeel ends). You will then follow the steps as appropriate for yourself.

After you have completed the ta'jeel/I'tithaar request, you will need to go to Idaratus Safar to request your visa in order to fly. (Also see the advice in step 9 about following up with the wakeel of your kulliyah if required.)

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I know if my ta'jeel request has been successful?

- Look at the IU dashboard page after you have logged into the university website. You will see the following screen:



You will know if your ta'jeel request has been successful as in this screenshot where it says 'الوضع العام' it will no longer say "منتظم" and instead it will say "مؤجّل" (the one who has taken ta'jeel). Also, you should see a reduced number of options available to click in the E-services section. Wait around a week inshaAllah after the end of the ta'jeel period for it to be processed, and if you have any concerns at any stage you can always go into your kulliyah/mahad and speak to them about it.

Q: Can I apply for ta'jeel from the UK?

- Technically you can apply for ta'jeel from the UK as it is done online. However, you need to be mindful of the outcomes (e.g. giving up your room – you will need to arrange for your belongings to be taken out of your room and to give back the key). Also, if there are any problems/issues with your request or there are additional steps required for your ta'jeel request to be processed, then you will not be present in Saudi to be able to address these. You may therefore need to make alternative arrangements.

Q. Can I delete my ta'jeel request (that I have already submitted) if I change my mind?

- See the screenshot at Step 12 above. Under where it says "حذف", you will see an **"X"** that should be clickable. This seems to be the delete button to delete your ta'jeel request that you have submitted. However, I have not tried this before myself, so I cannot say for certain. If in doubt, contact your kulliyah/mahad with how best to delete the ta'jeel request inshaAllah, as you may need to follow up with them to make sure they have not actioned your ta'jeel request already, and they will also need to put you back into your classes to study inshaAllah.

Q. If I know I want to take ta'jeel next semester, should I just stay in the UK and not return back to Madinah on my current Exit-Re-entry visa (at the end of the summer holidays)?

- It is not recommended to do this, as this can cause more problems that you will have to resolve. Doing this will cause your current exit-re-entry visa to expire. Therefore, if you wish to return after 1 semester, you may need to get the current expired visa renewed (as the Jamiah will see that your current status is outside of the kingdom, so you will not be given a new Exit-Re-entry visa because you have already exited and not returned). In order to do this, you may also need to pay a 100SR fine for every month that your visa has expired (you would also need to arrange for this payment to be paid in Saudi Arabia, not in the UK).

  All of these tasks will also become more complicated if your iqamah or passport expire and/or need renewing. With very complex cases there may be a need to do the entire visa process again. In order to avoid these problems, it is best to return back to Saudi Arabia on your current Exit Re-entry visa, and then get a new Exit-Re-entry Visa issued.

Wallahu alim.